

# The triangle inequality



1

a i

- $7 + 12 > 17$
- $7 + 17 > 12$
- $17 + 12 > 7$

ii Yes

b i

- $3.2 + 7.4 > 9.6$
- $3.2 + 9.6 > 7.4$
- $9.6 + 7.4 > 3.2$

ii Yes

c i

- $9 + 4 > 5$
- $9 + 5 > 4$
- $5 + 4 = 9$

ii Yes

d i

- $3.1 + 7.7 < 11.8$
- $3.1 + 11.8 > 7.7$
- $11.8 + 7.7 > 3.1$

ii No

2

a  $8 + 8 > 8$

b Yes

3

a Yes

b No

c No

4 The angle sum exceeds 180 degrees.

5

a  $9 < a < 43$

b  $7.4 < a < 41$

c  $7 < a < 35$

d  $17.6 < a < 75.8$

e  $12 < a < 44$

f  $0.8 < a < 4$

g  $10 < a < 44$

h  $7 < a < 43$

## Additional questions

6 The sum of the lengths of any two sides of a triangle is greater than the length of the third side.

$$AB + BC > AC \quad \text{and} \quad AB + AC > BC \quad \text{and} \quad AC + BC > AB$$

7

a Valid

b Not valid,  $4 + 7 \not> 12$

c Not valid,  $6 + 7 \not> 13$

8



a

- i  $17 + 26 > a$ , so  $43 > a$   
 $17 + a > 26$ , so  $a > 9$   
 $26 + a > 17$ , so  $a > -9$ , which is true  
 if  $a > 9$

- ii  $9 < a < 43$

b

- i  $15 + 18 > a$ , so  $33 > a$   
 $15 + a > 18$ , so  $a > 3$   
 $18 + a > 15$ , so  $a > -3$ , which is true  
 if  $a > 3$

- ii  $3 > a > 33$

9  $-\frac{3}{5} < x < 11$

- 10 He is correct that a valid triangle does not exist. The two doors just touching and forming a triangle would be a side length of  $2 \cdot 36 = 72$  inches. The other two sides are 16 inches and  $4.5 \cdot 12 = 54$  inches. However,  $16 + 54 \not> 72$ , so this is not a valid triangle.

His error is that just because they do not form a triangle, we cannot conclude that the doors do not touch. We can give a few different reasons for this:

- Although, the range of values that forms a triangle is  $38 < x < 70$ , this is a right triangle, so there is actually only one valid triangle with hypotenuse length of 56.32- which can be calculated with the Pythagorean theorem
- The doors will not ever touch if the sum of the two doors is less than the hypotenuse, which is not the case
- Since it is over the hypotenuse, the two doors will touch and form a quadrilateral

- 11 This is not a valid conclusion. This incorrectly assumes that Jacksonville, Orlando and Miami are all collinear. This is not necessarily the case, so they would form a triangle with vertices  $J$  for Jacksonville,  $O$  for Orlando, and  $M$  for Miami. Using the triangle inequality so we know that:

$JO + OM > JM$  or that  $OM > JM - JO$ , so the distance from Orlando to Miami is greater than 204 miles.